

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, a mix of clouds and sunshine, high 89. **Tonight**, partly cloudy, low 68. **Tomorrow**, sunshine giving way to clouds, afternoon thunderstorm, high 80. Weather map is on Page B8.

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THURSDAY, APRIL 16, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



Oleksiy Klochkovsky, who has driven parcels around northeastern Ukraine for four years, keeps one ear tuned for perils from above.

U.S. Jury Finds Concert Giant Is a Monopoly

By BEN SISARIO

A federal jury on Wednesday found that Live Nation, the concert giant that owns Ticketmaster, has operated as a monopoly in violation of federal and state antitrust laws, ending a closely watched trial in New York that could have far-reaching consequences in the music industry.

The verdict came after four days of deliberations in which the nine-person jury parsed a long list of questions it was asked to consider in a complex case that involved weeks of expert testimony.

The judge overseeing the case, Arun Subramanian, will determine remedies in a separate proceeding. That could include significant divestments by Live Nation, or even a breakup of Live Nation and Ticketmaster — an outcome that the federal government had called for when filing its case almost two years ago, though it is sure to be vigorously contested by Live Nation.

Live Nation will also face monetary damages as a result of the jury’s verdict in the case, which was brought by 33 states and Washington, D.C. The jury determined that Ticketmaster had overcharged consumers by \$1.72 for each ticket. The judge will next set an overall damages amount based on the jury’s finding.

During the seven-week trial, Live Nation consistently argued that it is not a monopoly, and that it competes aggressively — but legally — in a market filled with other ticketers, concert promoters, venue operators and sports teams.

Countering one of the government’s central claims, Live Nation also denied that it threatens ven-

Continued on Page A12

It’s Raining Bombs, but This Postman Delivers

THE GLOBAL PROFILE OLEKSIY KLOCHKOVSKY

By CASSANDRA VINOGRAD and OLEKSANDR CHUBKO

NEAR KHARKIV, Ukraine — Neither snow nor rain nor Russian glide bombs have kept Oleksiy Klochkovsky from making his appointed rounds for Nova Poshta, a private postal service in Ukraine.

For four years, Mr. Klochkovsky, 37, has been delivering parcels near the front line in northeastern Ukraine. Russian strikes have torched three of his trucks, and he’s had numerous close calls — shelling,

land mines, drones.

The stress, he acknowledged, is constant. But he is naturally upbeat. “I don’t know what would stop me, honestly,” he said with a smile. “Maybe only a bullet.”

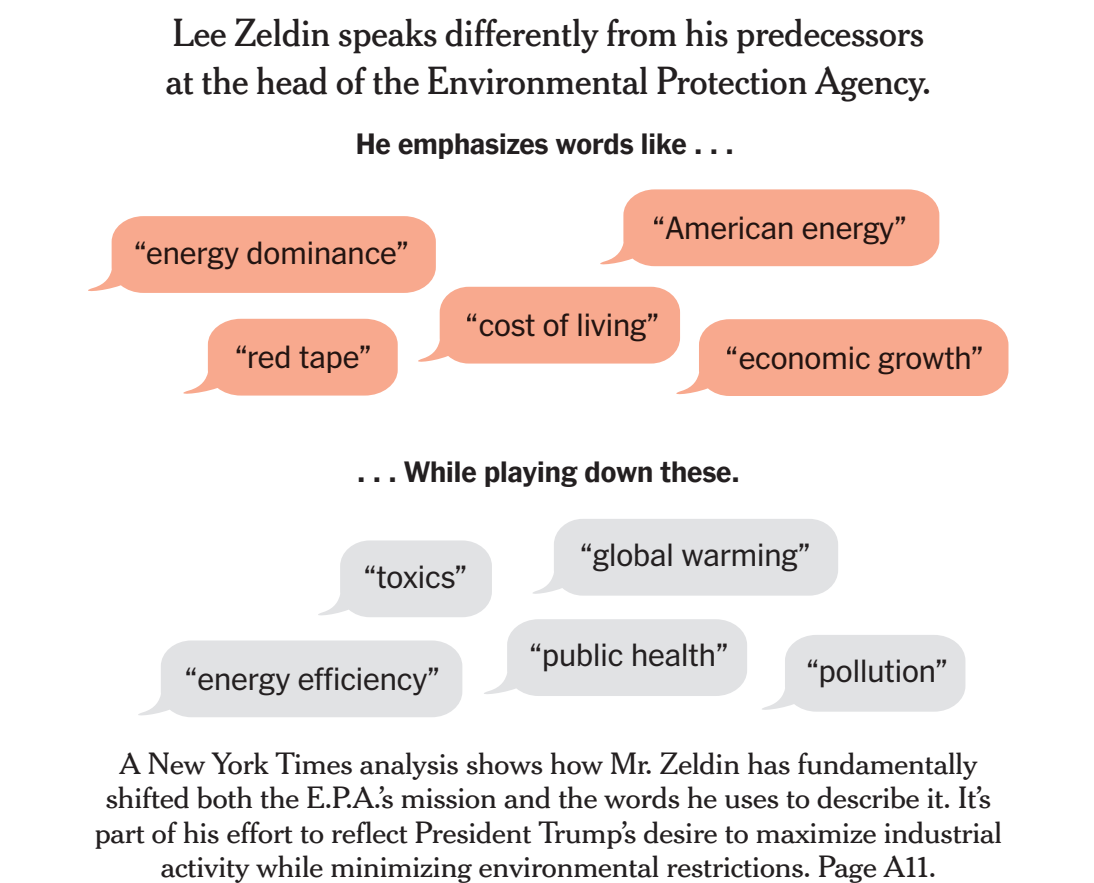
Mr. Klochkovsky braves the dangers for about \$450 a month.

He sees a larger mission. “It’s about the people” who cannot leave or “simply have nowhere else to go,” he said.

In frontline areas, local Nova Poshta branches are often the last remaining private businesses. Many Ukrainians view the company, which competes nationally against the state-owned mail service, Ukrposhta, as a shining success story and a lifeline for a country that has done its best to carry on.

Mr. Klochkovsky gets up every day at 8 a.m. (after hitting

Continued on Page A7



Exit of Swalwell Injects ‘Chaos’ Into California Governor’s Race

By LAUREL ROSENHALL and THEODORE SCHLEIFER

SACRAMENTO — One of the sleepest governor’s races in recent California history has turned into a mad scramble after the sudden departure of Eric Swalwell amid sexual assault allegations.

As soon as the first accusations hit Friday afternoon, Democratic candidates and potential donors blew up phones across California with text messages and phone calls. Social media users hyped their new favorites online.

And in a turbulent race that has grabbed the attention of voters thanks to Mr. Swalwell’s implosion, long shot candidates have newfound reason to believe they can still mount a last-minute comeback.

“Everyone just feels chaos and is scrambling,” said Marva Diaz, a

Candidates Scrambling for Available Backers

Democratic strategist who is the publisher of California Target Book, which handicaps state races.

Merely one week ago, Mr. Swalwell strode into a town hall at a Masonic lodge in Sacramento as a

Democratic front-runner who seemed confident he would be the next governor of California.

Now, he has resigned from Congress and faces criminal investigation, although he has denied the allegations against him. And several of his Democratic rivals appeared at a forum Tuesday night in the same capital city, trying to seize momentum in the race.

Under California’s nonpartisan

Continued on Page A13

Debt Alarms as Countries Respond to Energy Crisis

I.M.F. Warning of Risk as Officials Slash Taxes and Rack Up Public Subsidies

By ESHE NELSON

Germany cut fuel taxes for two months, costing \$1.9 billion. Canada announced a plan to slash taxes on gasoline, diesel and aviation fuels until early September — at a cost of \$1.7 billion. Those actions took place just in the past few days.

So far, since the war in the Middle East began, dozens of countries have cut taxes, subsidized energy bills and provided cash relief to households, racking up ever higher levels of emergency spending.

Now, with the prospects for a prolonged energy crisis growing, even if a cessation of fighting were to take hold, policymakers are raising alarms about public debt and urging governments to show restraint with their support measures.

On Wednesday, the International Monetary Fund acknowledged that the uncertainty created by the conflict would put pressure on lawmakers to increase their support for households, but warned that many countries were coping with stretched public finances, and some were staring down unsustainable debt levels.

“Fiscal policy must respond cautiously — providing support where needed without pushing public finances closer to the brink,” the Washington-based institution said in a report published Wednesday on its blog.

The risk is that the immediate economic costs of the conflict could balloon into a bigger fiscal crisis if governments increase borrowing to fund sweeping aid programs. Even after traffic eventually resumes through the Strait of Hormuz, the impact on supply chains for energy, fertilizers and other commodities could linger for months and possibly years. That means households and businesses would have to contend with sustained higher inflation and slower economic growth. At the same time, calls for more support will grow.

This month, Italy extended a fuel tax cut by a month, to the beginning of May, costing about \$590 million. In Australia, fuel tax cuts were expanded to provide additional relief worth about \$285 million, and legislation was introduced to extend cuts through June. In Greece, the government introduced a “fuel pass” to provide cash to drivers and motorcycle owners on low incomes, as part of a support package worth \$354 million, alongside other support for

Continued on Page A5

DÉTENTE AT RISK As Trump prepares to visit Beijing, his blockade angers China’s leader. PAGE A5

Stock Market Scales a New Peak As Investors Wager Peace Is Near

By JOE RENNISON

The S&P 500 hit a fresh record high on Wednesday, reflecting investors’ optimism that a peace deal would be reached before the war in Iran could inflict significant damage on corporate America.

The benchmark stock index, which is widely watched across the world as a barometer of the health of the U.S. market, rose about 0.8 percent to close above 7,000 and higher than its previous peak, reached in January. The index had already erased its losses during the war in Iran and now sits 2 percent higher than it was before the fighting began in late February.

Even as a spike in oil prices has led to a gloomier economic outlook, investors have been embracing signals in recent days that the United States and Iran could restart talks that ended last week-

end in Pakistan without a deal but with comments from President Trump that he believed the war was nearing an end.

The mere posture toward peace has helped to placate the stock market. Since the cease-fire took hold last week, investors have noted a shift in tone by the Trump administration that reflects a desire to end the conflict soon.

“The market is trading assuming we have seen the worst of the conflict,” said Stefano Pascale, an equity analyst at Barclays.

The S&P 500 is now on course for its third straight week of gains, the kind of winning streak not seen since October. The index has risen about 10 percent since March 30 — the nadir of the recent sell-off.

Still, some market watchers

Continued on Page A10

As He Warned of A.I.’s Danger, His Father Turned to Chatbots

By TEDDY ROSENBLUTH

Ben Riley discovered by accident that his dad hadn’t been telling the truth about his cancer.

He was sitting at the kitchen counter in his home in Austin, Texas, last summer, a bright new build with white walls and concrete floors, when he decided to peek at his dad’s MyChart portal. He idly scrolled through pages of lab results and doctor’s notes on his laptop until a sentence grabbed his attention.

“I was clear the window of treatment may close the longer he postpones,” the doctor wrote. “The natural history of his disease is death and debilitation.”

The note didn’t make sense. Ben knew that his 75-year-old father had chronic lymphocytic leukemia, a type of white blood cell cancer that is often slow-moving. But his dad, Joe Riley, had re-

JORDAN VONDERHAAR FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Ben Riley started a newsletter about artificial intelligence.

assured his family that starting treatment was not urgent. He certainly hadn’t conveyed his doctor’s warning that he was headed toward a dangerous deadline.

Ben, panicked, quickly clicked through more records. The oncol-

Continued on Page A16

BUSINESS B1-6

Michigan Woos Drone Makers

The state, known for making cars, is spending millions to bring new business to its auto suppliers.

PAGE B1

A Political Challenge Looms

Last year’s tax law raised I.R.S. refunds, but it’s unclear whether voters will be swayed by the policy.

PAGE B1

NATIONAL A9-17

Trump Threatens to Fire Powell

His term as Fed chairman ends May 15, but Powell says he won’t leave until a criminal investigation is over.

PAGE A10

Labor Secretary Scrutinized

The department is investigating personal texts among Lori Chavez-DeRemer, her aides and her family.

PAGE A10

INTERNATIONAL A4-8

A Church’s Disparity in Africa

The pope’s Cameroon visit highlights a divide between the growth of Catholicism on the continent, and the role Africans play in church leadership.

PAGE A8

SPORTS B7-10

Vonn Faces Long, Lonely Road

After an Olympic crash nearly caused her to lose a leg, the ski champion discussed her recovery and future.

PAGE B7

A Financial Blow for LIV Golf

Saudi Arabia’s sovereign wealth fund, facing rising pressures, is set to withdraw support from the league.

PAGE B10

THURSDAY STYLES D1-8

Decades in a Big, Bright City

With his new novel, Jay McInerney concludes a tetralogy about a New York couple that he started more than 30 years ago.

PAGE D7

OBITUARIES B11

‘The First Nerd to Enter Poker’

David Sklansky, an influential author and professional player, brought mathematical rigor into a card game once ruled by gut instincts. He was 78.

OPINION A18-19

Ann Curry

PAGE A19

ARTS C1-6

Looking Beyond Prison’s Bars

Adrien Brody and Tessa Thompson make their Broadway debuts in “The Fear of 13,” a death row drama based on a true story.

PAGE C1

0 354613 9